

The Cock's Ruse

It was the height of summer and everyone was complaining about the heat. Some men actually **shook their fists** at the sun. This made the sun very angry and he withdrew from the world.



The earth became cold and dark. People **begged** the sun's **forgiveness** and **pleaded** with him to come out again, but he refused.

The birds decided to send their own **emissary** and chose the **cock** for the **mission**.

The cock went to the sun's palace and told him about the **hardships** everyone was facing because of his absence in the sky. But the sun was unmoved.

"I will never **traverse** the skies again," he said. "You can tell everyone that."

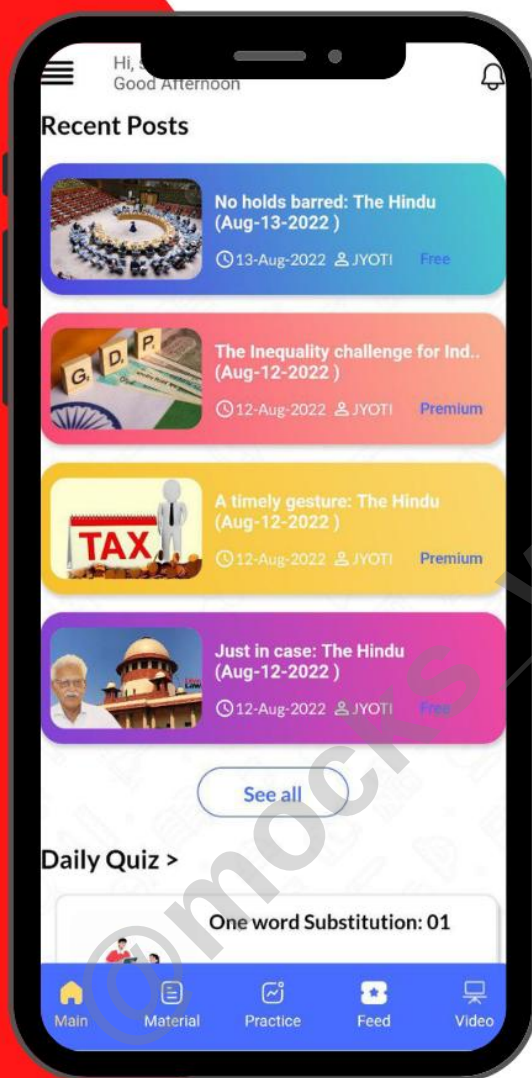
"That means I will have to go back home in the dark," said the cock, **admitting defeat**. "I'm sure the jungle cat is lying in wait for me. I will **crow** if she attacks me. Please come to my rescue."

The cock went some distance and then started crowing as loudly as he could. The sun **rushed out**. He went in search of the cock across the sky but the bird was nowhere to be seen. He had hidden himself.

The sun continues to come out when the cock crows **at dawn**. He goes in search of the bird across the world but never finds him.

Vocabulary

1. **Ruse** (noun) – trick, deception, ploy, stratagem, hoax – चाल
2. **Shake one's fist** (phrase) – show anger, threaten, express rage, gesture furiously, display aggression – गुस्से से मुट्ठी हिलाना
3. **Beg** (verb) – plead, implore, beseech, request, entreat – विनती करना
4. **Forgiveness** (noun) – pardon, mercy, clemency, absolution, compassion – क्षमा
5. **Plead** (verb) – request, appeal, beg, implore, urge – प्रार्थना करना
6. **Emissary** (noun) – messenger, envoy, delegate, ambassador, representative – दूत
7. **Cock** (noun) – rooster, fowl, bird, male chicken, chanticleer – मुर्गा
8. **Mission** (noun) – task, assignment, duty, expedition, operation – मिशन / कार्य
9. **Hardship** (noun) – difficulty, struggle, adversity, suffering, trouble – कठिनाई
10. **Traverse** (verb) – cross, pass through, travel, roam, navigate – पार करना
11. **Admit** (verb) – confess, acknowledge, concede, accept, reveal – स्वीकार करना
12. **Crow** (verb) – call, cry out, caw, squawk, shriek – बांग देना
13. **Rush out** (phrasal verb) – dash, hurry out, run out, burst out, emerge quickly – तेजी से बाहर निकलना
14. **At dawn** (phrase) – early morning, sunrise, daybreak, first light, morning twilight – सुबह होते ही / भोर में



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